

Brewell — the connected home fermentation system

The Problem

Home fermentation is having a moment. Kombucha, kefir, sourdough, kimchi — people want to make these at home and most give up, because fermentation needs stable temperature and consistent timing and a normal kitchen provides neither.

Our Solution

Brewell is a countertop appliance that holds temperature to within half a degree, tracks fermentation through onboard sensors, and tells you through the app when your batch is ready. Cartridge-based starter cultures remove the guesswork entirely.

The hardware design is complete. We have detailed CAD, a bill of materials costed at \$186 at a run of 10,000 units, and a manufacturing partner identified in Shenzhen. We have not built a physical prototype yet — that is the first use of this funding.

The Market

The home appliance market is enormous, and fermented foods are one of the fastest-growing segments in grocery. Interest in gut health continues to rise across every demographic.

Competition

There are several connected kitchen appliances. None of them do fermentation specifically.

The Team

I am the founder. I spent six years as a mechanical engineer in consumer electronics, and I have been fermenting at home for a decade. I am currently the only full-time person on the project and I am looking to bring on a co-founder with commercial experience.

Traction

Nothing to report yet. The product does not exist.

I have spoken to about forty people in fermentation communities and the interest is real, but I have not taken pre-orders and I did not want to before there is something to show.

Business Model

Hardware at a target retail price of \$349, with recurring revenue from starter culture cartridges at \$14 per pack.

The cartridge model is where the business is. Hardware margin at that price is thin.

Funding

I am raising \$1.2M to build a working prototype, run a small production batch, and validate demand properly through a crowdfunding campaign.